III

PART THREE · ⌖

The Covenant Daughters

Twelve women, one from each Dominion. One goes to the heir, two never come home, and the rest are married down the elite ladder.

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TR DOM FR 19–25

EDEN

Her full dossier is in Part I. Her path through the Trial is on the pages after the fates.

MARGINALIA

✣ *See also:* Vol. I, the Covenant Daughters of the 39th, 575.

Eleven more people

Every one of these women was raised somewhere specific, sorted by a Designation built for her Dominion, nominated by someone with a reason, and sent to the Crownward carrying more than the Broadcast will ever show. The Writing Rules ask for their own rhythms, so Eden, Ruth, Zara, Delphine, Petra and Abigail don't all sound like Imperial brochures (WR 15). These dossiers are where you find the rhythms.

Each dossier runs the same way. The portrait and the Registry card come first, then her Dominion, a faith and scripture spread, her path through the three phases, Eden and her, and a working page. The phase page prints what the files already give, beat by beat, and leaves the rest ruled. Under the Final Rulings, all thirty-nine Trials place Anointed Wives. One goes to the heir and the other eleven are married down the elite ladder as designated, and nobody goes home unassigned (FR 19). A candidate who dies has her status returned to her family, with no compensation and no punishment (FR 24). Rejection follows a woman "not in the record, in the room" (FR 25).

The twelve and their fates

TKC: TR · FR 19 · FR 24

CONFLICT

CONTENT NOTE Two deaths, one of them a killing. Injury and violence during Endurance.

DAUGHTER	DOMINION · AGE	ROLE	FATE (TR)
EDEN SELAH OSEI	Aurem · 21	Protagonist	Wins. The Anointed Wife of the 39th Trial.
DELPHINE FONTENOT	Gulf · 22	Genuine friend	Medically extracted during Endurance, a head injury on Day 1
MAREN COLE	Ardenne · 23	Knows too much	Knocked unconscious on Endurance Day 3 by Eden and Delphine, and left behind
CORINNE VALE	Meridian · 22	Malicious architect	Completes Endurance. Placement by composite score.
CALLA MERRITT	Vane · 21	The Broadcast's favorite	Dies on Endurance Day 2, pushed into the river by Corinne
NADIA ORIN	Irongate · 20	Heartbreakingly good	Withdraws before the Social Policy debate
RUTH GIDEON	Heartland · 22	True believer	Sent home before Endurance, Judah's trade to keep Sera
DELIA CROSS	Red Earth · 24	Grudge against Aurem	Reaches the final checkpoint, doesn't advance, becomes a Lady in Waiting
VIVIENNE HALE	Lone · 23	Wildcard observer	Ankle fails on a Day 1 slope. Extracted at the first checkpoint.
PETRA SOLANO	Mountain · 22	Came looking for love	Dies before Phase Two. A "sudden medical event." It isn't.
ZARA VOSS	Sable · 21	Underestimated	Reaches the final checkpoint and advances
SERA MONTOYA	Pacific · 24	The ally	Nearly removed before Endurance. Survives, reaches the final checkpoint, advances.

TKC: TR · FR 19

CONFLICT

OPEN QUESTION

WHERE THE FILES DISAGREE

CONFLICT · MAREN	The profile says she's eliminated before the Social Policy debate. The fates table has her in Endurance on Day 3 (TR).
CONFLICT · VIVIENNE	The profile says she's eliminated before the Social Policy debate. The fates table has her ankle failing on Endurance Day 1 (TR).
CONFLICT · DELPHINE AND MAREN	Delphine is extracted on Day 1 and helps knock Maren unconscious on Day 3 (TR). One of the two days has to move.
CONFLICT · THE FINAL CHECKPOINT	Zara is "one of the four women standing at the final checkpoint." Eden, Sera and Delia reach it too, and Corinne completes Endurance (TR). The count comes to five.
OPEN QUESTION · LADIES IN WAITING	The third- and fourth-place Endurance finishers (TR). Delia is one. Who's the other?
OPEN QUESTION · GOING HOME	The profiles send Maren, Nadia and Vivienne home. Under FR 19 nobody goes home unassigned. INFERENCE They go home with an elite-ladder assignment, and the wedding comes later.

HOW I'M RESOLVING EACH ONE

Eden, through the Trial

TKC: TR · CR · TL

VOL. I · 569 · 570 · EDEN'S DOSSIER, PART I

Her full dossier is in Part I. This is her path, beat by beat, as the files give it.

PHASE	WHAT THE FILES GIVE	CH.
Arrival · day five	She looks at the city before the cameras, carries her own bag, and walks slower than the choreography. Forty-seven seconds, the most discussed arrival in a decade (TR).	
The Settling	Sera meets her on the first day and makes a decision that afternoon (TR).	
Doctrinal Assessment	The most complex questions in eleven cycles, three written by the Prelate herself. Finishes forty minutes early, reconsiders two answers, changes one, correctly. The highest score in the Trial's history (TR).	
Theological Interview	Two hours. A report three pages longer than anyone's: aligned, or clear-eyed, and the officer can't tell which (TR).	
Public Testimony	Declines her handler in writing. A statement of faith in women's intelligence, defensible line by line and incendiary as a whole. Lyris looks at her hands, then at Judah, who's been watching Eden for six minutes. She moves from fourth to first (TR).	

The files call the Prelate "Prelate Naomi." Under FR 33 she's renamed, working name Aurelia (POSSIBLE).

THE THREE QUESTIONS THE PRELATE WROTE FOR EDEN HERSELF

TKC: TR · CR

VOL. I · 569 · 573 · 525

Eden, through the Trial, continued

CONTENT NOTE Violence during Endurance.

PHASE	WHAT THE FILES GIVE	CH.
The Dominion Forum	Moving the room within twenty minutes, by asking what the group actually has to decide. Four words to Sera in the hallway after (TR).	
The Civic Debates	She argues for the room and for the editor at once, so the Broadcast can't reshape her and can only deprioritize her (TR).	
The Anointed Evening	Eleven minutes with Lyris, three things off the record, the third a warning that's also instructions (TR)	
The Pairing	Judah sends the officials out and checks her for a wire. "Most candidates tell me they feel called." "I know." (TR)	
Endurance	Mountain terrain. On Day 3, with Delphine, she knocks Maren unconscious and leaves her (TR).	
The Declaration	She wins (TR). **OPEN QUESTION** The Crownward file calls it "the moment Eden will have planned for and the moment that will be taken from her" (CR). What's taken?	
Covenant Week	Seven days, a residence on the Palace grounds, her score replaced by The Chosen, and the Anointing on the sixth day (CR)	

THE BEAT THE FILES DON'T HAVE YET THAT THE BOOK NEEDS MOST

PORTRAIT · DELPHINE FONTENOT · TWENTY-TWO · GULF DOMINION

PART III · COVENANT DAUGHTER II · ⌖

DELPHINE

*Warm in a way that's genuine and dangerous, and the Empire's scoring system has never known what to do with it (**TL**).*

ON THE RECORD

Delphine Fontenot of Port Seraphine, twenty-two. First in Gulf's Regional Assessment. The genuine friend (**TR**).

HER FATE

Medically extracted during Endurance after a head injury on Day 1 (**TR**). Married down the elite ladder as designated (**FR 19**).

TKC: TR · DOM

VOL. I · 538 · 513 · 514

Port Seraphine

Covenant Registry

GULF DOMINION · PORT SERAPHINE

CANDIDATE	*FONTENOT, Delphine · twenty-two*
NOMINATED BY	*a colleague of her father's at the Temple* (**TR**)
REGIONAL ASSESSMENT	*first*
MOTHER	*Vowed, then a Bonded Wife, by choice* (**TR**)

COVENANT DAUGHTER

HER MOTHER	A Vowed woman who chose love over status and became a Bonded Wife. Delphine watched every shift, which rooms her mother could enter, whose attention she held, what she could say, and carries a quiet fury for her that Port Seraphine taught her to wear as warmth (**TR**).
HER DOMINION	The most culturally intact in the Empire. Music survived here, standing in plain sight, because "cultural pilgrimage" pays too well to stop it. Girls walk the Procession at fourteen, and every year the crowd turns it into a second line (**DOM**).
IN THE TRIALS	Gulf candidates have historically been penalized for warmth, which Crown advisors read as performance. A Gulf woman who knows the gap between what she shows and what she keeps is one of the most dangerous women in the room (**DOM**).
HOW SHE MOVES	Rhythmically. She laughs sincerely, and she disarms people who've spent careers learning not to be disarmed. The Crownward will try to correct her, and it won't succeed (**TR**). She works a room and opens doors through conversation (**WR 29**).

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

HER FATHER'S WORK AT THE TEMPLE, AND WHAT HE THINKS OF HER ENTERING

TKC: TR · DOM

VOL. I · 538 · 513 · 518

WHAT SHE BELIEVES

WHO TAUGHT HER	A Vowed mother and a Temple father (TR), in a city where the Vowed "have learned to look away from certain things" (DOM).
WHAT SHE BELIEVES	INFERENCE Joy can be a form of survival. The Last Free Night tells a bride the truth "in the one language the Empire has never learned how to police properly" (DOM).
WHAT SHE PRACTICES	Music at Bindings, against three ordinances. The Procession and its counter-rhythm. Three-day funerals with a second line to the grave, and then the Quiet (DOM).
WHAT SHE'D BE ARRESTED FOR	INFERENCE Anywhere but Gulf, most of what she grew up doing in church.

WHAT THE TEMPLE TEACHES ABOUT A WOMAN LIKE HER

Warmth reads as performance unless it comes from someone the Crown already trusts (DOM). POSSIBLE The Temple sets 1 Peter 3.4, "the ornament of a meek and quiet spirit," against everything Port Seraphine taught her.

THE HYMN SHE HUMS WHEN SHE FORGETS THE CAMERAS

The text

HER NAME	*Delphine* has no biblical source. It's French, from the Greek for Delphi, the oracle's town.
MIRIAM'S TIMBREL · EXODUS 15.20	**POSSIBLE** The women follow Miriam "with timbrels and with dances." **Where it breaks:** Miriam sings at the sea in front of everyone. Gulf's music survives as an exception the Empire won't admit exists (**DOM**).
DAVID DANCING · 2 SAMUEL 6	**POSSIBLE** A king dances before the ark with all his might, and his wife watches from a window and despises him. **Where it breaks:** Nobody in the Crownward is going to dance, and Delphine knows exactly who's watching from the windows.
LYDIA · ACTS 16.14–15	**POSSIBLE** A woman whose household opens and who "constrained us" to stay. Hospitality as a form of power (Vol. I, 408).

SHE'D QUOTE	NEVER READ TO HER IN THE TEMPLE
Ecclesiastes 3.4, "a time to mourn, and a time to dance"	Psalm 149.3, "Let them praise his name in the dance"
	Psalm 150.4, "Praise him with the timbrel and dance"

> **VOLUME ONE**
>
> Gulf, 538. Lived religion, 513 and 514. Miriam, 388. David, 412. The women who ran things, 408.

EXOD 15.20

2 SAM 6.14–16

PS 149.3

PS 150.4

ECCL 3.4

ACTS 16.14–15

1 PET 3.4

TKC: TR · DOM

CONFLICT

Through the Trial

CONTENT NOTE A head injury during Endurance.

PHASE	WHAT THE FILES GIVE	YOURS
Arrival	Gulf candidates arrive fluent in being watched (**DOM**)	
Phase One · the Temple		
Phase Two · the Crown		
Endurance · Day 1	A head injury, and medical extraction (**TR**)	
Endurance · Day 3	With Eden, knocks Maren unconscious (**TR**)	
After	Married down as designated (**FR 19**)	

CONFLICT Extracted on Day 1, and with Eden on Day 3 (**TR**). Decide which day moves.

THE MOMENT THE CROWNWARD TRIES TO CORRECT HER, AND WHAT SHE DOES WITH IT

Eden and Delphine

TKC: TR · WR 29

THE FILES	The genuine friend (**TR**). Her social skill shows physically and isn't explained (**WR 29**).

THE FIRST THING DELPHINE DOES THAT MAKES EDEN TRUST HER

WHAT EDEN THINKS OF HER THE NIGHT SHE'S EXTRACTED

LINES ONLY DELPHINE WOULD SAY

WRITING

Write her working a room

Ten minutes. A reception room in the Crownward, Delphine in the middle of it, and three people who've decided not to like her.

WRITE

☐ POSSIBLE ☐ OPEN QUESTION ☐ DECIDED

LOG NO. _____ DATE _____



PORTRAIT · MAREN COLE · TWENTY-THREE · DOMINION OF ARDENNE

TKC: TR · DOM

VOL. I · 540

PART III · COVENANT DAUGHTER III · ⌖

MAREN

*She's carrying knowledge she doesn't fully understand, and she came looking for the context that makes it make sense (**TR**).*

ON THE RECORD

Maren Cole of Ashford, twenty-three. Self-nominated, four months of paperwork, second in Ardenne's Regional Assessment (**TR**).

HER FATE

Knocked unconscious on Endurance Day 3 by Eden and Delphine, and left behind in Mountain terrain (**TR**). **CONFLICT** Her profile has her eliminated before the Social Policy debate.

TKC: TR · DOM

VOL. I · 540 · 514

Ashford and the Hollows

Covenant Registry

DOMINION OF ARDENNE · ASHFORD

CANDIDATE	*COLE, Maren · twenty-three*
NOMINATED BY	*herself · four months of paperwork (**TR**)*
REGIONAL ASSESSMENT	*second*
FATHER	*Crown officer, Ashford*
MOTHER	*from the mountain communities · came to Ashford at eighteen (**TR**)*

COVENANT DAUGHTER

TWO WORLDS	One official, one quiet. She learned early that the difference between them mattered and could be dangerous (**TR**).
WHAT SHE CARRIES	Ashford sits close to classified operations in the outer territory. She absorbed the Empire's mountain work in fragments, not through access (**TR**).
HER DOMINION	Ashford is the city the Empire keeps as proof Ardenne is pacified, and everything past the tree line says otherwise. The Ungoverned have their deepest roots in the hollows, where the mountain people call them something closer to saints (**DOM**).
IN THE TRIALS	Ardenne rarely sends a Covenant Daughter. When it does she's usually from Ashford, more Imperial than the hollows, and quiet about the gap (**DOM**).

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

THE FRAGMENT SHE HEARD AS A GIRL THAT SHE'S BEEN TRYING TO UNDERSTAND EVER SINCE

TKC: TR · DOM

VOL. I · 540 · 514

WHAT SHE BELIEVES

WHO TAUGHT HER	An Ashford father in Crown service and a mother from the hollows (TR). INFERENCE Two catechisms, one recited and one never written down.
WHAT HER MOTHER'S PEOPLE PRACTICE	Marriage as a community declaration and a broom jumped. The First Winter Work, a real job in the community's survival at thirteen or fourteen. The Sitting, so the dead don't leave alone (DOM).
WHAT SHE BELIEVES	OPEN QUESTION Which of the two catechisms she reaches for when she's frightened.

WHAT THE TEMPLE TEACHES ABOUT A WOMAN LIKE HER

Ashford's devotion is loud because watched people perform loyalty where it can be seen (DOM). POSSIBLE The Temple teaches Ardenne girls Romans 13.1, "Let every soul be subject unto the higher powers," and calls the women in the hollows criminals.

WHAT HER MOTHER TOLD HER ABOUT THE HOLLOWS, AND WHAT SHE LEFT OUT

The text

2 KGS 5.2–3

2 KGS 6.15–17

PS 121.1

ROM 13.1

HER NAME	*Maren* has no biblical source. It's a Scandinavian form of Marina, "of the sea."
THE SERVANT GIRL · 2 KINGS 5	**POSSIBLE** A captive girl from Israel tells her mistress the general could be healed by the prophet in Samaria. She knows something the powerful household doesn't. **Where it breaks:** Her knowledge sends a general to be healed. Maren's gets her left on a mountain.
ELISHA'S SERVANT · 2 KINGS 6	**POSSIBLE** Surrounded, the servant sees only the enemy, until his eyes are opened and "the mountain was full of horses and chariots of fire" (6.17). **Where it breaks:** What's hidden in Maren's mountains belongs to the Empire.

SHE'D QUOTE	NEVER READ TO HER
Psalm 121.1, "I will lift up mine eyes unto the hills, from whence cometh my help"	2 Kings 6.17, the mountain full of what you can't see

> **VOLUME ONE**
>
> Ardenne, 540. Lived religion, 514. Mountain, and the classified work, 551. Passages put to work, with Romans 13, 454.

TKC: TR

CONFLICT

Through the Trial

CONTENT NOTE Violence during Endurance.

PHASE	WHAT THE FILES GIVE	YOURS
Arrival		
Phase One · the Temple		
Phase Two · the Crown	Eliminated before the Social Policy debate (TR, profile)	
Endurance · Day 3	Knocked unconscious by Eden and Delphine, and left behind in Mountain terrain (TR, fates)	
After	What she does on her way out with what she learned is "not recorded" (**TR**)	

CONFLICT Eliminated in Phase Two, or in Endurance on Day 3 (**TR**). One has to go.

WHAT SHE LEARNS IN THE CROWNWARD THAT FINALLY MAKES THE FRAGMENTS MAKE SENSE

Eden and Maren

TKC: TR

THE FILES	Eden and Delphine leave her unconscious on the mountain (**TR**).

WHY EDEN DOES IT, AND WHETHER MAREN EVER KNOWS

WHAT MAREN KNOWS THAT EDEN NEEDS

LINES ONLY MAREN WOULD SAY

WRITING

Write her waking up

Ten minutes. Mountain terrain, Day 3, and no one in sight.

WRITE

☐ POSSIBLE ☐ OPEN QUESTION ☐ DECIDED

LOG NO. _____ DATE _____

PORTRAIT · CORINNE VALE · TWENTY-TWO · DOMINION OF MERIDIAN

PART III · COVENANT DAUGHTER IV · ⌖

Corinne

*Precision as a weapon, compliance as strategy, and the most dangerous woman in every room she's ever entered (**TL**).*

ON THE RECORD

Corinne Vale of Blessed Shore, twenty-two. First in Meridian's Regional Assessment, and the most connected Covenant Daughter in the Trials' history (**TR**).

HER FATE

Completes Endurance, placed by composite score (**TR**). She pushes Calla Merritt into the river on Day 2, and no camera sees it (**TR**).

TKC: TR · DOM

VOL. I · 542 · 514

Blessed Shore

Covenant Registry

DOMINION OF MERIDIAN · BLESSED SHORE

CANDIDATE	*VALE, Corinne · twenty-two*
REGIONAL ASSESSMENT	*first*
THE CROWNWARD	*Quarterly Audiences attended · the Court wives known · three visits to the Crown Palace (**TR**)*

COVENANT DAUGHTER

WHAT SHE IS	The machinery of the Trials "in the way that a key embodies the lock it was made for" (**TR**).
WHY SHE'S DANGEROUS	Her ruthlessness comes from conviction. She believes she's the right choice, so she treats a threat as an obstacle to what's right, which makes her more dangerous than a girl who only likes winning (**TR**).
HER DOMINION	Blessed Shore holds the Covenant Court's secondary chambers. Its administrators trust process, its Stewardwives read Binding contracts in Reading Circles, and a Meridian woman who decides to move is almost impossible to stop because she's read every rule and knows where the gaps are (**DOM**).
OPEN QUESTION	She shares a surname with Maribel Vale of Aurem (**DR3**). Related?

HER FAMILY, AND WHAT HER MOTHER TAUGHT HER ABOUT CONTRACTS

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

HER FAMILY, AND WHAT HER MOTHER TAUGHT HER ABOUT CONTRACTS

TKC: TR · DOM

VOL. I · 542 · 509

WHAT SHE BELIEVES

WHAT SHE BELIEVES	She's the right choice, and so whatever she does is right (TR).
WHO TAUGHT HER	INFERENCE Blessed Shore, where Designation tests "relational compliance" over three days and preparing daughters for high-stakes assessment is what families do (DOM).
WHAT SHE CAN RECITE	INFERENCE All of it, and the clauses.
WHAT SHE'D BE ARRESTED FOR	Murder, if a camera had seen it (TR).

WHAT THE TEMPLE TEACHES ABOUT A WOMAN LIKE HER

INTERPRETATION Nothing against her. She's what the Trials reward, built for it from birth (TR). POSSIBLE Her Temple holds her up as Proverbs 31 in person.

THE VERSE SHE TELLS HERSELF ON THE BANK OF THE RIVER

The Text

GEN 4.8–10

GEN 25.29–34

1 KGS 21

PHIL 3.6

ROM 8.31

1 COR 1.12

CONTENT NOTE Murder.

HER NAME	*Corinne* is from the Greek *Korinna*, "maiden," and has no biblical source. **INTERPRETATION** It sounds like Corinth, the church Paul wrote to about its factions, each one saying "I am of Paul" or "I of Apollos" (1 Cor 1.12).
CAIN · GENESIS 4	**POSSIBLE** The first killing, in a field, with no one there to see it. "The voice of thy brother's blood crieth unto me from the ground" (4.10). **Where it breaks:** God asks Cain where his brother is. Nobody asks Corinne, because no camera was there.
JACOB'S STEW · GENESIS 25	**POSSIBLE** A birthright bought with a bowl of food from a hungry brother. Corinne uses food as a weapon (TR).
JEZEBEL'S LETTERS · 1 KINGS 21	**POSSIBLE** A man killed by correct procedure, through letters and sealed witnesses. Corinne builds a parallel intelligence operation from the Trial's own surveillance (TR). **Where it breaks:** Jezebel's crime has a prophet waiting at the vineyard.

SHE'D QUOTE	NEVER READ TO HER
Romans 8.31, "If God be for us, who can be against us?"	Genesis 4.10, the blood crying from the ground
	Philippians 3.6, Paul's zeal described as the thing he had to lose

> **VOLUME ONE**
>
> Meridian, 542. Genesis, the primeval history, 254. Jezebel, 397. Ruth and the other foreign women, 391.

TKC: TR

Through the Trial

CONTENT NOTE Murder, and a trap set for another candidate.

PHASE	WHAT THE FILES GIVE	YOURS
The Tea Party	The tension with Calla begins here and runs through every shared event (**TR**)	
Throughout	Food as a weapon. A parallel intelligence operation among the Covenant Houses, built from the surveillance (**TR**).	
Before Endurance	Sets the trap that nearly removes Sera (**TR**)	
Endurance · Day 2	Pushes Calla into the river. No camera. One person sees it and can't look away fast enough (**TR**).	
After	Completes Endurance, placed by composite (**TR**). Married down as designated (**FR 19**).	

WHO SEES HER AT THE RIVER, AND WHAT SHE DOES ABOUT IT

Eden and Corinne

TKC: TR · TL

THE FILES	Two women raised for opposite reasons to understand exactly how the Trials work. Corinne was built for the lock (**TR**). Eden read the small print (**TR, DR3**).

THE FIRST TIME EDEN SEES WHAT CORINNE IS

WHAT CORINNE THINKS EDEN IS

LINES ONLY CORINNE WOULD SAY

WRITING

Write the Tea Party

Ten minutes. The first shared event, Corinne and Calla, and something on a plate.

WRITE

☐ POSSIBLE ☐ OPEN QUESTION ☐ DECIDED

LOG NO. _____ DATE _____



PORTRAIT · CALLA MERRITT · TWENTY-ONE · DOMINION OF VANE

PART III · COVENANT DAUGHTER V · ⌖

CALLA

*Legacy, carried lightly and warmly until it isn't (**TL**).*

ON THE RECORD

Calla Merritt of Saint Meridian, twenty-one. A Broadcast family, and the Broadcast's favorite, because she's what it's decided the Trials should produce without any manipulation required (**TR**). Her surname is Merritt (**Ruling**).

HER FATE

CONTENT NOTE Her death.

Pushed into the river by Corinne on Endurance Day 2 (**TR**). Her status goes back to her family, with no compensation and no punishment (**FR 24**).

TKC: TR · TL · DOM · RULING

VOL. I · 544 · 561

Saint Meridian

Covenant Registry

DOMINION OF VANE · SAINT MERIDIAN

CANDIDATE	*MERRITT, Calla · twenty-one*
FATHER	*Broadcast, a mid-level editor (**TR**)*
MOTHER	*a former Covenant Daughter (**TR**)*
PREPARED SINCE	*childhood (**TR**)*

COVENANT DAUGHTER

WHAT SHE KNOWS	Broadcast cues, camera patterns, the kind of attention that reads as grace on a screen. Her talent is real, and the performance has become her identity (**TR**).
HER MOTHER	A former Covenant Daughter who withdrew in Phase Three of an earlier Trial (**TR**). The timeline says the 32nd (**TL**).
HER DOMINION	The legacy Dominion. Some families have sent daughters to three Trials running, and high-scoring girls are prepared for candidacy from the time they can read (**DOM**). The Broadcast Assessment at sixteen makes exceptional girls minor public figures overnight (**DOM**).
CONFLICT	The 32nd Trial was in 2097, when Calla was fourteen, and a Covenant Daughter can't already be a mother. INFERENCE Her mother's Trial was earlier, and the "32nd" belongs to someone or something else.

WHICH TRIAL HER MOTHER WAS IN, AND WHY SHE WITHDREW

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHICH TRIAL HER MOTHER WAS IN, AND WHY SHE WITHDREW

TKC: TR · DOM

VOL. I · 544 · 515

WHAT SHE BELIEVES

WHO TAUGHT HER	A mother who withdrew and a father who edits (TR). INFERENCE She learned faith as something performed well.
WHAT SHE BELIEVES	OPEN QUESTION Whether anything under the performance is hers.
HER DOMINION'S UNDERGROUND	Ghost Marriages outside registration, and the Ghost Declaration, where a boy says what he actually intends before saying what's required (DOM).

WHAT THE TEMPLE TEACHES ABOUT A WOMAN LIKE HER

INTERPRETATION That she's the Trials working as designed. The Broadcast doesn't have to manipulate her, because she already is what it wants (TR).

THE ONE MOMENT IN THE CROWNWARD WHERE SHE ISN'T PERFORMING, AND WHO SEES IT

The text

SONG 2.2

MATT 6.28–29

GEN 4.8

JUDG 11.37–40

PS 69.2

CONTENT NOTE Her death.

HER NAME	The calla lily, from the Greek *kallos*, beauty. It has no biblical source. **INTERPRETATION** *Merritt* sounds like merit, and she was raised to earn it.
THE LILY · SONG 2.2	**POSSIBLE** "As the lily among thorns, so is my love among the daughters." **Where it breaks:** The lily in the Song is loved. Calla is watched.
ABEL · GENESIS 4	**POSSIBLE** Killed in a field by a rival, out of sight. **Where it breaks:** Abel's blood cries from the ground. The Empire's paperwork returns Calla's status to her family and moves on (**FR 24**).
JEPHTHAH'S DAUGHTER · JUDGES 11	**POSSIBLE** A daughter who dies for what her father's world required, and whom the daughters of Israel lamented four days a year. **Where it breaks:** Nobody in the Empire is going to lament Calla on a calendar.

SHE'D QUOTE	NEVER READ TO HER
Matthew 6.28, "Consider the lilies of the field"	Psalm 69.2, "I am come into deep waters, where the floods overflow me"

VOLUME ONE

Vane, 544. The unnamed, with Jephthah's daughter, 401. The Trials' history, 561. The Declaration, and a candidate's death, 573.

TKC: TR · FR 23–24

Through the Trial

CONTENT NOTE Her death by drowning.

PHASE	WHAT THE FILES GIVE	YOURS
Early	Warm, the legacy carried lightly, rooms settling around her (**TR**)	
The Tea Party	The tension with Corinne begins (**TR**)	
Throughout	The Broadcast's favorite (**TR**)	
Endurance · Day 2	The water's moving fast. Corinne pushes her in. One person sees it and can't look away fast enough (**TR**).	
After	Her status goes back to her family. A candidate's death doesn't downgrade the Trial (**FR 23–24**).	

HOW THE BROADCAST REPORTS HER DEATH, AND WHAT HER FATHER, THE EDITOR, DOES WITH THE FOOTAGE

Eden and Calla

TKC: TR

WHAT EDEN ENVIES IN HER, AND WHAT EDEN PITIES

THE LAST THING CALLA SAYS TO ANYONE

LINES ONLY CALLA WOULD SAY

WRITING

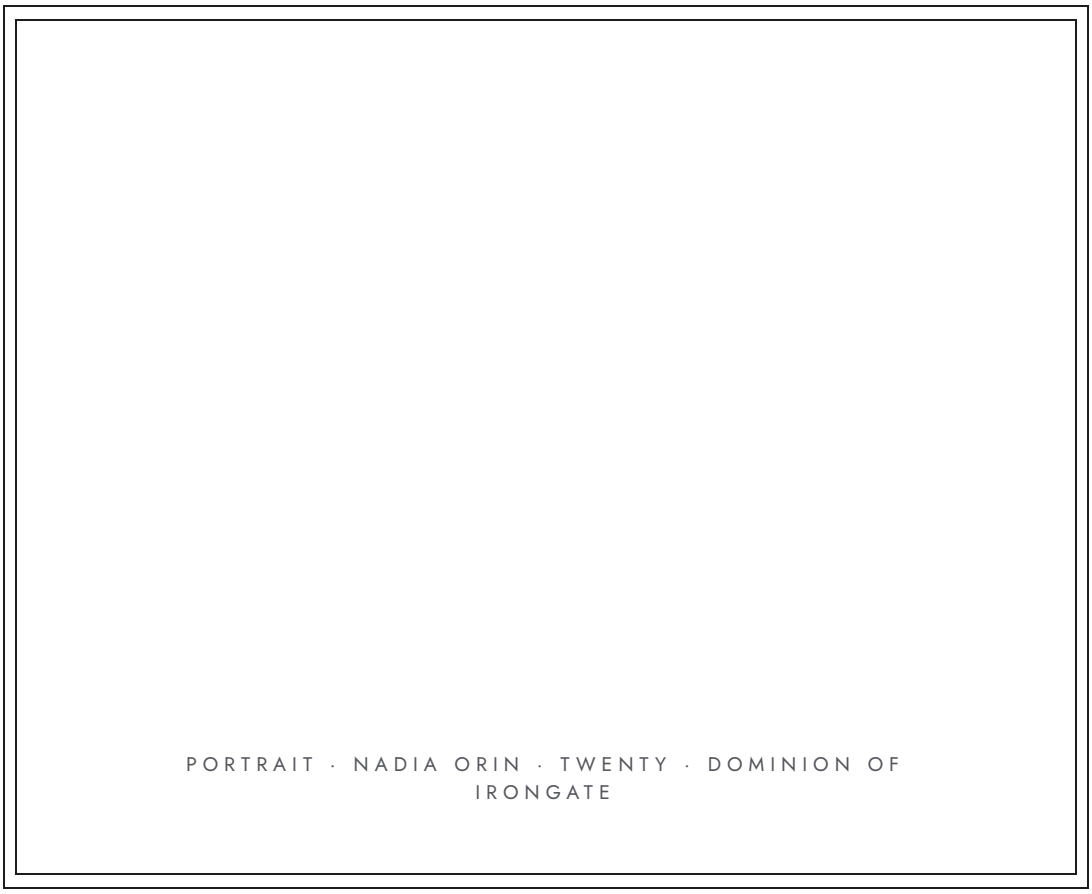
Write her mother watching

Ten minutes. Saint Meridian, the Broadcast on, a former Covenant Daughter watching her own daughter on the screens.

WRITE

☐ POSSIBLE ☐ OPEN QUESTION ☐ DECIDED

LOG NO. _____ DATE _____



PORTRAIT · NADIA ORIN · TWENTY · DOMINION OF IRONGATE

PART III · COVENANT DAUGHTER VI · ⌖

NADIA

*The Trial identifies her as eliminated. The people who know her would use a different word (**TR**).*

ON THE RECORD

Nadia Orin of Iron Benediction, twenty. The most working-class Covenant Daughter in the Trials' history, a fact the Broadcast can't decide how to handle (**TR**).

HER FATE

Withdraws before the Social Policy debate, and the circumstances aren't made public. She goes home and does something meaningful with what she learned (**TR**).

TKC: TR · DOM

VOL. I · 545 · 515

Iron Benediction

Covenant Registry

DOMINION OF IRONGATE · IRON BENEDICTION

CANDIDATE	*ORIN, Nadia · twenty*
NOMINATED BY	*a Vowed officer (**TR**)*
MOTHER	*Commonwife*
FATHER	*factory worker*
DISTRICT	*labor*

COVENANT DAUGHTER

HER PARENTS	They genuinely love each other, which isn't small in a system that treats love as a function, and Nadia understands both truths (**TR**).
HER NOMINATION	A Vowed officer saw something in her that the labor district's schools weren't built to recognize (**TR**).
HER DOMINION	The most class-divided in the Empire. The labor-district women run a mutual aid network so invisible the Vowed have never mapped it, and they call it the Kitchen. Blues and jazz went underground in 2053 (**DOM**).
IN THE TRIALS	Irongate almost always sends administrative daughters, because selection rewards polish. When a labor-district girl gets through, she adapts in real time instead of applying a prepared answer (**DOM**).

THE VOWED OFFICER WHO NOMINATED HER, AND WHAT THAT OFFICER SAW

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

THE VOWED OFFICER WHO NOMINATED HER, AND WHAT THAT OFFICER SAW

TKC: TR · DOM

VOL. I · 545 · 515 · 518

WHAT SHE BELIEVES

WHAT SHE BELIEVES	She chooses kindness knowingly. She believes in the Empire's ideals even understanding their corruption (TR).
WHO TAUGHT HER	Two parents who love each other, and the Kitchen (TR, DOM). The Placement at fourteen, a community's assessment of what she's suited for and what it needs (DOM).
WHAT SHE PRACTICES	Mutual aid that the Vowed have never mapped (DOM).

WHAT THE TEMPLE TEACHES ABOUT A WOMAN LIKE HER

POSSIBLE The labor districts hear "if any would not work, neither should he eat" (2 Thess 3.10) and "Servants, be obedient to them that are your masters" (Eph 6.5). Nadia hears them and believes the ideal underneath anyway.

THE IDEAL SHE BELIEVES IN, STATED THE WAY SHE'D SAY IT

The text

ACTS 9.36–39

MARK 12.41–44

MIC 6.8

JAS 5.4

2 THESS 3.10

EPH 6.5

HER NAME	*Nadia* has no biblical source. It's from the Slavic word for hope.
TABITHA · ACTS 9	**POSSIBLE** The only woman the New Testament calls a disciple in the feminine, whose widows hold up the garments she made when she dies (Vol. I, 408). The Kitchen is Tabitha's widows with a name. **Where it breaks:** Tabitha is raised and goes back to the work. Nadia's work starts when she goes home.
THE WIDOW'S TWO MITES · MARK 12	**POSSIBLE** She gives "all that she had," and Jesus says she gave more than the rich. **Where it breaks:** The widow's gift is unseen by everyone but him. Nadia's withdrawal is unseen by the public on purpose (**TR**).

SHE'D QUOTE	NEVER READ TO HER
Micah 6.8, "to do justly, and to love mercy, and to walk humbly with thy God"	James 5.4, the hire of the labourers "kept back by fraud, crieth"

> **VOLUME ONE**
>
> Irongate, 545. Lived religion, 515. The women who ran things, with Tabitha, 408. Passages put to work, 454.

TKC: TR · TL

Through the Trial

PHASE	WHAT THE FILES GIVE	YOURS
Arrival	The Broadcast can't decide how to handle her (**TR**)	
Phase One · the Temple		
Phase Two · the Crown	Withdraws before the Social Policy debate. The circumstances aren't stated (**TR, TL**).	
After	Home to Iron Benediction, to do something meaningful with what she learned (**TR**). Married down as designated (**FR 19**).	

WHY SHE WITHDRAWS, AND WHO KNOWS THE REAL REASON

Eden and Nadia

TKC: TR

WHAT TWO GIRLS FROM LABOR HOUSEHOLDS RECOGNIZE IN EACH OTHER

WHAT NADIA SAYS WHEN SHE LEAVES

LINES ONLY NADIA WOULD SAY

WRITING

Write her coming home

Ten minutes. Iron Benediction, the labor district, the Kitchen, and everyone who watched her on the screens.

WRITE

☐ POSSIBLE ☐ OPEN QUESTION ☐ DECIDED

LOG NO. _____ DATE _____

PORTRAIT · RUTH GIDEON · TWENTY-TWO · HEARTLAND DOMINION

PART III · COVENANT DAUGHTER VII · ⌖

RUTH

*Genuine faith as credential and liability at once. She says "see you soon" like it's a promise, and means it (**TL**).*

ON THE RECORD

Ruth Gideon of Providence Cross, twenty-two. First in Heartland's Regional Assessment. The true believer, sincere without being foolish (**TR, WR 26**).

HER FATE

Sent home before Endurance, as the price Judah pays to keep Sera in the Trials. She goes home believing she wasn't enough. She was more than enough (**TR**).

TKC: TR · DOM

VOL. I · 547 · 515

Providence Cross

Covenant Registry

HEARTLAND DOMINION · PROVIDENCE CROSS

CANDIDATE	*GIDEON, Ruth · twenty-two*
NOMINATED BY	*her grandmother (TR)*
REGIONAL ASSESSMENT	*first*
FATHER	*a Temple deacon*
MOTHER	*teaches theology*

COVENANT DAUGHTER

HER FAMILY	Her grandmother attended the first Covenant Trial in 2065 and nominated Ruth, believing she exemplified the Trials' stated purpose. She may have misunderstood what the actual purpose is (TR).
HER FAITH	She grew up believing in the Trials and the divine order they stand for, genuinely, without the doubt most candidates carry with it. She's more theologically sophisticated than she lets on (TR).
HER DOMINION	The Heartland didn't need conquering. People sing the hymns because they mean them, and real believers have opinions about what faithfulness requires. Heartland women questioning the Commonwife designation call it theological inquiry, and mean it (DOM).

WHAT HER GRANDMOTHER REMEMBERS OF THE FIRST TRIAL, IN 2065

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHAT HER GRANDMOTHER REMEMBERS OF THE FIRST TRIAL, IN 2065

TKC: TR · DOM · WR 26

VOL. I · 547 · 515 · 518

WHAT SHE BELIEVES

WHAT SHE BELIEVES	The Trials and the divine order are real and good (TR). Her faith is real, and her curiosity is careful in public (WR 26).
WHO TAUGHT HER	A deacon father, a mother who teaches theology, and a grandmother who was there in 2065 (TR). The First Covenant at thirteen, scripture memorized and a gift to the Temple, the moment her track was set in public (DOM).
WHAT SHE GIVES EDEN	The clearest look Eden gets at faith from the inside, an uncomfortable gift (TR).
WHAT SHE PRACTICES	The Anointing, hair washed and braided the night before a Binding, each woman speaking a private word over the bride. Planting something after a burial (DOM).

WHAT THE TEMPLE TEACHES ABOUT A WOMAN LIKE HER

A girl who believes is more useful to the Empire than a girl who performs belief (DOM). The most dangerous Heartland candidates learned to make their questions sound like prayers (DOM).

THE QUESTION SHE'S BEEN ASKING SINCE CHILDHOOD, WORDED AS A PRAYER

The text

RUTH 1.16–17

JUDG 6.36–40

JUDG 8.22–23

1 SAM 8.11–18

HER NAMES	Ruth, the Moabite who binds herself to her mother-in-law with the most famous vow in scripture (Vol. I, 391). Gideon, who tests God with a fleece twice and later refuses a crown: "the LORD shall rule over you" (Judg 8.23).
WHERE RUTH BREAKS	**POSSIBLE** Ruth's vow binds her to a person and a people, and they keep faith with her. Ruth Gideon's loyalty to the Empire is repaid by being traded away (**TR**).
WHERE GIDEON BREAKS	**POSSIBLE** Gideon asks God for proof, and gets it. Ruth asks the Empire nothing and believes.

SHE'D QUOTE	NEVER READ TO HER
Ruth 1.16, "whither thou goest, I will go"	Judges 8.23, a judge refusing to found a dynasty
	1 Samuel 8.11–18, what a king will take

> **VOLUME ONE**
>
> Ruth, 391 and 113. Kingmakers, with Gideon, 413. Heartland, 547. Faith that isn't performance, 518.

TKC: TR · TL

Through the Trial

PHASE	WHAT THE FILES GIVE	YOURS
Phase One · the Temple	Exceptional, as in every phase she takes part in (TR)	
Phase Two · the Crown	Exceptional (TR)	
Before Endurance	Sent home. Judah trades her to keep Sera. She doesn't know (TR).	
Leaving	"See you soon," like a promise (TL)	
After	Believes she wasn't enough (TR). Married down as designated (FR 19).	

HOW SHE'S TOLD, BY WHOM, AND WHAT SHE SAYS

Eden and Ruth

TKC: TR · TL · WR 26

THE RULE	Ruth believes the Empire more than Eden does, and that doesn't make her foolish (**WR 26**).

THE CONVERSATION WHERE RUTH SHOWS EDEN FAITH FROM THE INSIDE

WHAT EDEN OWES HER, AND WHETHER SHE EVER PAYS IT

LINES ONLY RUTH WOULD SAY

WRITING

Write her train home

Ten minutes. Ruth on the transport back to Providence Cross, praying for the women still there.

WRITE

☐ POSSIBLE ☐ OPEN QUESTION ☐ DECIDED

LOG NO. _____ DATE _____



PORTRAIT · DELIA CROSS · TWENTY-FOUR · DOMINION OF RED EARTH

PART III · COVENANT DAUGHTER VIII · ⌖

DELIA

*Perfectly prepared, perfectly composed, absolutely unreadable. She's been deciding something for months before she nods (**TL**).*

ON THE RECORD

Delia Cross of Canaan's Gate, twenty-four. Second in Red Earth's Regional Assessment, selected over the first-ranked girl because of concerns about that girl's family history (**TR**).

HER FATE

Reaches the final checkpoint and doesn't advance. Becomes a Lady in Waiting, and what she does with the position is the most significant thing she does in the Crownward (**TR**).

TKC: TR · DOM

VOL. I · 548 · 516

Canaan's Gate

Covenant Registry

DOMINION OF RED EARTH · CANAAN'S GATE

CANDIDATE	*CROSS, Delia · twenty-four*
REGIONAL ASSESSMENT	*second · selected over the first (**TR**)*
MOTHER	*Stewardwife*
FATHER	*Crown officer · transferred from Aurem when she was six (**TR**)*

COVENANT DAUGHTER

THE TRANSFER	A Crown efficiency initiative moved her family from the Empire's showcase Dominion to its policy testing ground. She's known since she was six what it means that Aurem is celebrated and Red Earth is proof (**TR**).
WHAT SHE CARRIES	The anger of a girl told all her life that the place she left was better than the place that raised her. Polished and composed in public, angrier and more frightened in private (**TR**).
HER DOMINION	Red Earth piloted the Commonwife quota in 2058, and its women have lived under the full version longest. Under the performance runs a language of small signals refined over decades. Its candidates are the best in the Empire at performing compliance while thinking something else, and the council places them mid-pack until it realizes "middle was a choice, not a ceiling" (**DOM**).

WHAT SHE REMEMBERS OF AUREM FROM BEFORE SHE WAS SIX

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHAT SHE REMEMBERS OF AUREM FROM BEFORE SHE WAS SIX

TKC: TR · DOM

VOL. I · 548 · 516

WHAT SHE BELIEVES

WHO TAUGHT HER	A Stewardwife mother, and Red Earth, where the morning after a Binding mothers take daughters aside for the Second Covenant, what the first one means and what a daughter may keep for herself (DOM).
WHAT SHE PRACTICES	The small signals, a way of folding hands, a phrase that means something other than what it says (DOM). Women sitting with the dead in shifts, and burial at midday so the body knows the sun's warmth (DOM).
WHAT SHE BELIEVES	OPEN QUESTION The files give her anger and her shift, and not her God.

WHAT THE TEMPLE TEACHES ABOUT A WOMAN LIKE HER

Red Earth is the most visibly religious Dominion, with scripture on every building and the Vowed embedded as "pastoral care" (DOM). POSSIBLE The Temple preaches Philippians 2.14, "Do all things without murmurings," to the women who invented a language for murmuring.

THE SMALL SIGNAL SHE USES MOST, AND WHAT IT MEANS

The text

LUKE 15.25–32

ESTH 4.4

ESTH 4.16

PHIL 2.14

HER NAME	*Delia* has no biblical source. It's Greek, "from Delos," a title of Artemis. **INTERPRETATION** *Cross* is the heaviest surname in the cast, and nobody says so.
THE ELDER BROTHER · LUKE 15	**POSSIBLE** The son who stayed and served, furious when the father kills the fatted calf for the one who left. "Lo, these many years do I serve thee... and yet thou never gavest me a kid" (15.29). **Where it breaks:** The father goes out to him and says "all that I have is thine" (15.31). The Empire never goes out to Red Earth.
ESTHER'S MAIDENS · ESTHER 4	**POSSIBLE** The young women who serve the queen, tell her what's happening outside, and fast with her when it matters (4.4, 4.16). **Where it breaks:** Delia ends up serving the Aurem girl. Whether she fasts with her is the book.

SHE'D QUOTE	NEVER READ TO HER
Luke 15.29, if she ever said it aloud	Luke 15.31, "Son, thou art ever with me"

> **VOLUME ONE**
>
> Red Earth, 548. Lived religion, 516. Esther, 399. Commonwives and the quota, 527.

TKC: TR · TL

Through the Trial

PHASE	WHAT THE FILES GIVE	YOURS
Phase One · the Temple		
The Dominion Forum	Votes with Eden (**TL**)	
Social Policy debate	Votes with Eden (**TL**)	
Endurance	Her alignment has shifted in a direction she didn't expect. She makes a choice she'll have to live with and reaches the final checkpoint (**TR**).	
After	Doesn't advance. Lady in Waiting (**TR**).	

THE CHOICE SHE MAKES IN ENDURANCE

Eden and Delia

TKC: TR · TL

THE FILES	A grudge against Aurem (TR), and two votes with Eden anyway (TL).

WHAT DELIA DECIDED OVER THOSE MONTHS, AND WHEN SHE NODDED

WHAT SHE DOES AS A LADY IN WAITING THAT MATTERS MOST

LINES ONLY DELIA WOULD SAY

WRITING

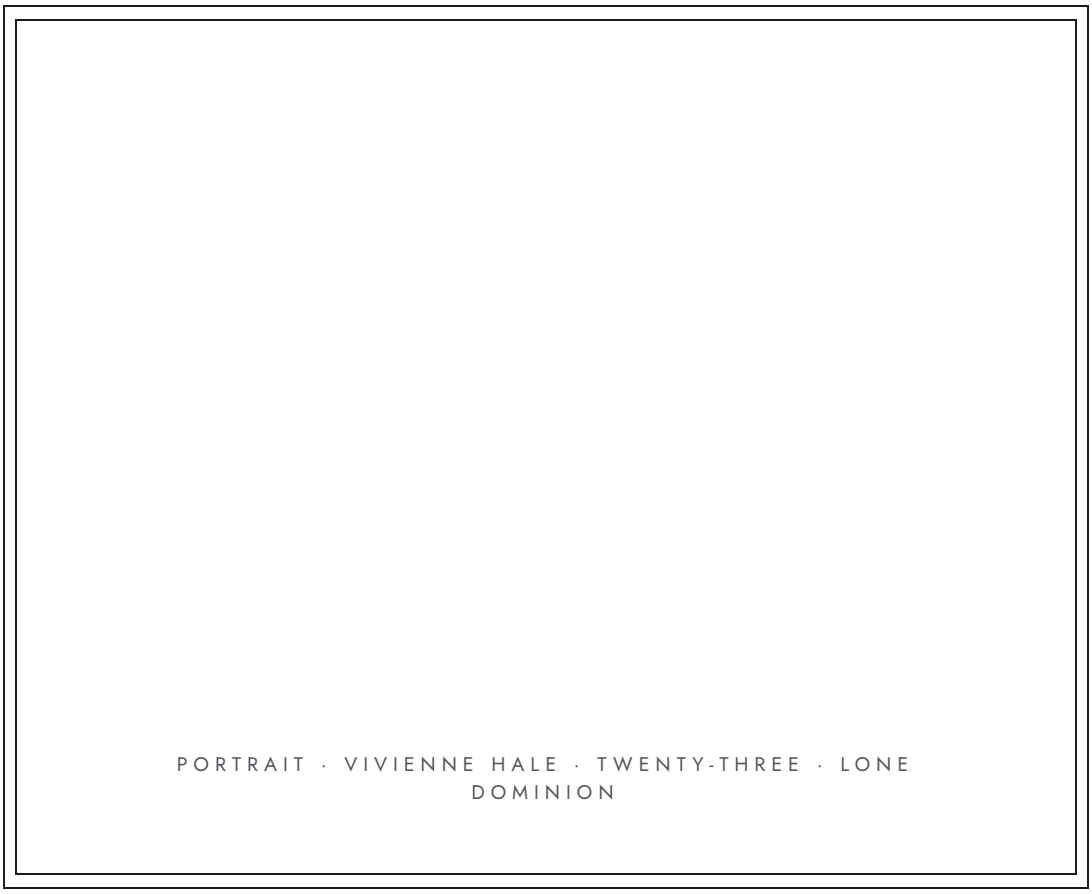
Write the Forum vote

Ten minutes. The scenario room, no leader, Eden moving the room, and Delia deciding.

WRITE

☐ POSSIBLE ☐ OPEN QUESTION ☐ DECIDED

LOG NO. _____ DATE _____



PORTRAIT · VIVIENNE HALE · TWENTY-THREE · LONE DOMINION

PART III · COVENANT DAUGHTER IX · ⌖

VIVIENNE

*Curious rather than ambitious, engaged without being revealing, and noncommittal in a way that reads as easy and is actually a skill (**TR**).*

ON THE RECORD

Vivienne Hale of Covenant Basin, twenty-three. Self-nominated on impulse after two years of thinking about it. Third in Lone's Regional Assessment (**TR**).

HER FATE

Her ankle fails on a Day 1 slope in Endurance, and she's extracted at the first checkpoint (**TR**). She goes home knowing more about how the Crownward works than anyone there will know what to do with (**TR**).

TKC: TR · DOM

VOL. I · 550 · 516

Covenant Basin

Covenant Registry

LONE DOMINION · COVENANT BASIN

CANDIDATE	*HALE, Vivienne · twenty-three*
NOMINATED BY	*herself (TR)*
REGIONAL ASSESSMENT	*third*
SELECTED BECAUSE	*clean and interesting, and to avoid a nepotism story about the first-ranked girl (TR)*

COVENANT DAUGHTER

HER FAMILY	Pragmatic and quietly independent. Her father works in resource extraction. Her mother runs the household and treats Imperial loyalty as a practical arrangement rather than a conviction (TR).
HER DOMINION	Texas negotiated its surrender and kept the attitude. Lone performs loyalty loudly and then does what it was going to do anyway, and its outer-territory women have an autonomy that would get them flagged in Aurem (DOM).
IN THE TRIALS	If a Lone girl is selected she goes, the Dominion supports her adequately, and nobody gets emotional about the outcome. Lone directness: do the thing, see what happens (DOM).

WHAT SHE WAS THINKING ABOUT FOR TWO YEARS BEFORE SHE FILED

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHAT SHE WAS THINKING ABOUT FOR TWO YEARS BEFORE SHE FILED

TKC: TR · DOM

VOL. I · 550 · 516

WHAT SHE BELIEVES

WHO TAUGHT HER	A mother for whom loyalty is a practical arrangement (TR). The First Ride, a long distance navigated alone while the community waits. The Giving, something of a grandmother's handed to a bride (DOM).
WHAT SHE BELIEVES	OPEN QUESTION Curiosity is the only creed on file (TR).
WHAT SHE PRACTICES	Burial with boots on, ready for wherever the dead go next (DOM).

WHAT THE TEMPLE TEACHES ABOUT A WOMAN LIKE HER

POSSIBLE Lone gets Proverbs 31.27, "She looketh well to the ways of her household," and the Governor-Prelate never checks whether anyone listened (DOM).

WHAT SHE WAS GIVEN AT THE GIVING, OR WILL BE

The text

HER NAME	*Vivienne* has no biblical source. It's from the Latin *vivus*, "alive."
THE QUEEN OF SHEBA · 1 KINGS 10	**POSSIBLE** She comes from far away to see for herself, asks hard questions, and says "the half was not told me" (10.7). **Where it breaks:** Sheba goes home with gifts and a story she's free to tell. Vivienne goes home with information nobody in Covenant Basin can use (TR).
THE SPIES · NUMBERS 13	**POSSIBLE** Twelve men sent to look at a land and come back with a report. **Where it breaks:** Their report is public, and argued over. Vivienne's report is hers.

SHE'D QUOTE	NEVER READ TO HER
1 Kings 10.7, "the half was not told me"	Joshua 2, a woman who reads the whole war correctly from her window

> **VOLUME ONE**
>
> Lone, 550. Lived religion, 516. Rahab, 391. Numbers, the count and the camp, 155.

1 KGS 10.1–7

MATT 12.42

NUM 13.25–33

JOSH 2

TKC: TR

CONFLICT

Through the Trial

CONTENT NOTE An injury during Endurance.

PHASE	WHAT THE FILES GIVE	YOURS
Phase One · the Temple		
Phase Two · the Crown	Eliminated before the Social Policy debate (TR, profile)	
Endurance · Day 1	Her ankle fails on a slope. Extracted at the first checkpoint (TR, fates).	
After	Home to Covenant Basin with more than anyone there can use (**TR**). Married down as designated (**FR 19**).	

CONFLICT Phase Two, or Endurance Day 1 (**TR**). One has to go.

THE SINGLE MOST USEFUL THING SHE LEARNED, AND WHO SHE TELLS

Eden and Vivienne

TKC: TR

WHAT VIVIENNE NOTICES ABOUT EDEN THAT NOBODY ELSE DOES

LINES ONLY VIVIENNE WOULD SAY

WRITING

Write her report

Ten minutes. Vivienne back in Covenant Basin, telling one person what the Crownward actually is.

WRITE

☐ POSSIBLE ☐ OPEN QUESTION ☐ DECIDED

LOG NO. _____ DATE _____



PORTRAIT · PETRA SOLANO · TWENTY-TWO · MOUNTAIN DOMINION

PART III · COVENANT DAUGHTER X · ⌖

PETRA

*She came looking for something. She found it (**TL**).*

ON THE RECORD

Petra Solano of Crestfall, twenty-two. Nominated by a Vowed officer and approved by the Crown (**TR**). She matters by doing less (**WR 28**).

HER FATE

CONTENT NOTE Her death.

Dies before Phase Two. The Empire calls it a sudden medical event, and it isn't (**TR**). Her death costs the Trial nothing, and her status goes back to her family (**FR 23–24**).

TKC: TR · DOM

VOL. I · 551 · 517

Crestfall

Covenant Registry

MOUNTAIN DOMINION · CRESTFALL

CANDIDATE	*SOLANO, Petra · twenty-two*
NOMINATED BY	*a Vowed officer (**TR**)*
APPROVED BY	*the Crown (**TR**)*
STATED PURPOSE	*the Trials*
ACTUAL PURPOSE	_____

COVENANT DAUGHTER

THE BOY NEXT DOOR	She grew up beside a family whose youngest son she loved, the way children who grow up together do. The family relocated where she couldn't follow, and she kept looking, the way you look for something you believe can still be found (**TR**).
WHY SHE ENTERED	To get into the Crownward, where the records and archives are. The boy disappeared into Mountain terrain four years ago, and the official record doesn't hold his name (**TR**).
WHY SHE WAS CHOSEN	**POSSIBLE** Someone in the Crown's advisory structure suspected she was looking for something and wanted her looking where they could intercept it. If so, the control failed (**TR**).
HER DOMINION	Crestfall is the face and the mountains are the truth. Girls chosen at Designation for classified Vowed service disappear from public life (**DOM**).

THE BOY'S NAME, AS SHE KNEW IT

WHAT SHE BELIEVES

TKC: TR · DOM · WR 28

VOL. I · 551 · 517

WHAT SHE BELIEVES	**INFERENCE** That what's lost can still be found if you keep looking (**TR**).
WHO TAUGHT HER	Crestfall, where discipline mattered before the Empire made it doctrine. Families take their sons above the city the night before assessment and show them the mountains, which were there before the Empire and will be there after (**MEN**).
WHAT SHE PRACTICES	The Witness Walk. The name spoken once, directly to the mountain, which Crestfall trusts more than God or the Temple, and then the long walk down where the grief happens (**DOM**).

WHAT THE TEMPLE TEACHES ABOUT A WOMAN LIKE HER

POSSIBLE The Temple reads the Song of Songs only as an allegory of Christ and the church, which is an old and real tradition, so the Song's woman searching the streets for the one she loves is never read as a woman.

WHAT SHE SAYS TO THE MOUNTAIN, AND WHOSE NAME

MATT 16.18

SONG 3.1–4

SONG 5.6–7

SONG 8.6

THE TEXT

CONTENT NOTE Her death.

HER NAME	Greek *petra*, "rock," the word behind "upon this rock I will build my church" (Matt 16.18, Vol. I, 417).
THE WOMAN SEARCHING · SONG 3	**POSSIBLE** "I will rise now, and go about the city... I will seek him whom my soul loveth" (3.2). She finds him and won't let him go. **Where it breaks:** Petra goes about the city and finds the archive instead.
THE WATCHMEN · SONG 5.7	**POSSIBLE** The second time she searches, "the watchmen that went about the city found me, they smote me, they wounded me." **Where it breaks:** The Song keeps going after the watchmen. Petra's story doesn't.

SHE'D QUOTE	NEVER READ TO HER
Song 3.2, "I will seek him whom my soul loveth"	Song 5.7, the watchmen
	Song 8.6, "love is strong as death"

> **VOLUME ONE**
>
> Mountain, 551. Lived religion, 517. The three arguments, with the Song of Songs, 127. The ledger and the Dissent, 492.

Through the Trial

TKC: TR · FR 23–24 · FR 41–42

CONTENT NOTE Her death.

PHASE	WHAT THE FILES GIVE	YOURS
Arrival	Mountain candidates carry the alertness of someone raised knowing what she doesn't know might be classified (**DOM**)	
Phase One	The east wing archive holds things that are not about Azrael and are about Azrael at the same time. What she finds there is why she's dead (**TR**).	
Before Phase Two	Dies. "A sudden medical event," the Empire's phrase for Azrael too (**TR, TL**).	
After	Her status goes back to her family. The Trial loses nothing (**FR 23–24**).	

OPEN QUESTION How does a Covenant Daughter get into the east wing archive, which Azrael reached only through a Crown advisory access period (**FR 41**)?

WHAT SHE FINDS, AND WHO KNOWS SHE FOUND IT

TKC: TR · WR 28

Eden and Petra

THE RULE	Her stillness, her watching, her refusal to react or perform can be stronger than dialogue. Don't overexplain her (**WR 28**).

THE ONE THING PETRA DOES THAT EDEN DOESN'T UNDERSTAND UNTIL AFTER

WHO THE BOY IS, AND HOW HE'S TIED TO AZRAEL

Write the archive

WRITING

Ten minutes. The east wing, a drawer, and Petra reading something about a boy whose name isn't in it.

WRITE

☐ POSSIBLE ☐ OPEN QUESTION ☐ DECIDED

LOG NO. _____ DATE _____

TKC: TR · TL · DOM · WR 27

VOL. I · 553



PORTRAIT · ZARA VOSS · TWENTY-ONE · DOMINION OF SABLE

PART III · COVENANT DAUGHTER XI · ⌖

ZARA

*Two Sable women are worth five from anywhere else. Her real name is Tazaleh, and the Empire doesn't have it (**TL**).*

ON THE RECORD

Zara Voss of Sable Reach, twenty-one. Nominated by her mother. Excelled in Sable's Regional Assessment. Underestimated on arrival, and she doesn't stay underestimated (**TR**).

HER FATE

One of the women standing at the final checkpoint, and she advances to final consideration (**TR**).

Sable Reach and the desert

TKC: TR · TL · DOM

VOL. I · 553 · 517

Covenant Registry

DOMINION OF SABLE · SABLE REACH

CANDIDATE	*VOSS, Zara · twenty-one*
NOMINATED BY	*her mother (TR)*
MOTHER	*Unbound · raised her alone*
FATHER	*unnamed (TR)*
DESERT NAME	*not on file*

COVENANT DAUGHTER

HER GRANDMOTHER	Her real name is one the desert knows and the Empire doesn't. She raised Zara with the Sable education: the land, the plants, and the patience of someone who reads an environment that kills you if you misread it (TR).
HER FATHER	Unnamed, the way the desert is unnamed. It exists, it shaped everything, and it doesn't need documentation (TR).
HER DOMINION	The Empire sees the desert and sees geography to manage. Sable women see a teacher (TR). The Empire renamed the cities and not the land, and the scoring process has no rubric for silence as calculation (DOM).
IN THE TRIALS	The Trial has had three cycles to learn what two Sable women are worth, and hasn't adjusted. Zara's been counting on that (TR).

WHAT HER GRANDMOTHER TAUGHT HER FIRST

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

WHAT HER GRANDMOTHER TAUGHT HER FIRST

WHAT SHE BELIEVES

TKC: TR · TL · DOM

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WHO TAUGHT HER	Her grandmother and the desert (TR). The Finding, a girl left at a family site from sunset to sunrise, and what she brings back becomes her adult name in the community (DOM).
WHAT SHE CARRIES	Two names, as Sable women do, one the Empire knows and one that lives in the house where it can't reach (TR). Hers is Tazaleh (TL).
WHAT SHE PRACTICES	The Desert Walk before a Binding. The dead given back to the desert, the name said once into a fire that nobody puts out (DOM).

WHAT THE TEMPLE TEACHES ABOUT A WOMAN LIKE HER

The Empire doesn't know desert names exist (DOM). POSSIBLE The Temple teaches that the name the Registry holds is the name God knows.

WHAT SHE BROUGHT BACK FROM THE FINDING, AND HOW IT BECAME TAZALEH

GEN 38.27–30

MATT 1.3

GEN 16.13

ISA 35.1

REV 2.17

DEUT 8.2

THE TEXT

HER NAME	*Zara* is the King James spelling of Zerah, Tamar's twin (Matt 1.3, Gen 38.30, Vol. I, 417). At the birth his hand comes out first and the midwife ties a scarlet thread on it, "This came out first." His brother breaks out ahead of him (Gen 38.28–30).
WHERE IT BREAKS	**POSSIBLE** Zerah is marked first and born second, and the royal line runs through his brother. Zara is marked last and doesn't stay there.
HAGAR · GENESIS 16	**POSSIBLE** A woman alone in the desert who names God, "Thou God seest me" (16.13). **Where it breaks:** Hagar is found in the desert. Zara was raised to be at home in it.

SHE'D QUOTE	NEVER READ TO HER
Isaiah 35.1, "the desert shall rejoice, and blossom as the rose"	Revelation 2.17, a white stone with "a new name written, which no man knoweth saving he that receiveth it"
Genesis 16.13, "Thou God seest me"	Genesis 38, which the Temple doesn't teach (Vol. I, 386)

> **VOLUME ONE**
>
> Sable, 553. Lived religion, 517. Tamar and the twins, 386. Hagar, 384. The names in the cast, 417.

Through the Trial

PHASE	WHAT THE FILES GIVE	YOURS
Arrival	Underestimated (TR)	
Phase One · the Temple		
Phase Two · the Crown		
The middle of the book	The name exchange with Eden (Vol. I, 553)	
Endurance	Standing at the final checkpoint (TR)	
After	Advances to final consideration (TR)	

WHAT SHE DOES IN ENDURANCE THAT NONE OF THE OTHERS COULD

TKC: TR · TL · WR 27

Eden and Zara

THE RULE	She can say the quiet thing, and she still knows where she is. She isn't there to explain the scene's politics (**WR 27**).
THE EXCHANGE	**INTERPRETATION** Sable's two-name custom and Celeste's house name for Eden are the same instinct in two Dominions (Vol. I, 553).

THE NIGHT THEY TRADE NAMES. WHO OFFERS FIRST, AND WHAT EACH NAME COSTS TO SAY.

LINES ONLY ZARA WOULD SAY

Write her at the final checkpoint

Ten minutes. Mountain terrain, the end of Day 3, and Zara reading the land the way the desert taught her.

WRITE

☐ POSSIBLE ☐ OPEN QUESTION ☐ DECIDED

LOG NO. _____ DATE _____

TKC: TR · TL · DOM

VOL. I · 555

PORTRAIT · SERA MONTOYA · TWENTY-FOUR · PACIFIC DOMINION

PART III · COVENANT DAUGHTER XII · ⌖

SERA

*"Monitor closely" is on her record before she arrives. She has to outscore everyone by enough that the judgment becomes impossible to sustain, and she does (**TL**).*

ON THE RECORD

Sera Montoya of Westhold, twenty-four. She entered not to win but to find the person she'd been waiting for (**TR**).

HER FATE

Nearly removed before Endurance. Survives, reaches the final checkpoint, and is one of three who advance. Her flag is updated after the Trial, and the new notation isn't public (**TR**).

Westhold

Covenant Registry

PACIFIC DOMINION · WESTHOLD

CANDIDATE	*MONTOYA, Sera · twenty-four*
CLASS	*Westhold's administrative class (**TR**)*
FLAG	*Monitor closely · on file before arrival*
REVIEW	*every Pacific score reviewed at Crownward level (**DOM**)*

MONITOR CLOSELY

HER GRANDMOTHER	At the last protest before the Partition Agreement ended Pacific's resistance in 2041. She tells it as a caution and not a hero's story, because knowing when and how is the difference between impact and loss (**TR**).
HOW SHE WATCHES	One eye on the Empire's architecture and the other on the gap between what it claims and what it does. Her patience is the patience of someone waiting for the moment worth acting on (**TR**).
HER DOMINION	More cameras per block than anywhere, a Governor-Prelate Dorian appointed himself, and mothers who teach daughters how to pass the Designation without revealing themselves. Pacific candidates arrive trained to be watched, and the ones who last learn to watch back (**DOM**).

THE PROTEST, AS HER GRANDMOTHER TELLS IT

WRITING

FROM THE FACING PAGE

THE PROTEST, AS HER GRANDMOTHER TELLS IT

WHAT SHE BELIEVES

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WHO TAUGHT HER	Her grandmother, and Westhold, where the dead are buried facing west, toward the ocean and the direction of the secession (DOM).
WHAT SHE BELIEVES	INFERENCE That two people who see clearly are more dangerous than one (TR).
WHAT SHE PRACTICES	The Real Binding, a private ceremony with the promises a couple actually means. Facing West, the dawn ceremony where a boy turns back toward the city (DOM).

WHAT THE TEMPLE TEACHES ABOUT A WOMAN LIKE HER

Pacific girls are reviewed for inherited resistance, for any sign the secession story survived in the children (DOM). POSSIBLE The Temple preaches Romans 13.2 in Westhold more than anywhere, "whosoever therefore resisteth the power, resisteth the ordinance of God."

WHAT SHE'D PROMISE AT A REAL BINDING, IF SHE EVER HAD ONE

GEN 46.17

NUM 26.46

1 SAM 18.1–3

1 SAM 20

ECCL 3.7

JUDG 9.8–15

ROM 13.2

The text

HER NAME	Serah, daughter of Asher, one of the few daughters named in the genealogies (Gen 46.17, Num 26.46). In later Jewish tradition she lives for centuries, is the one who tells Jacob that Joseph is alive, and shows Moses where Joseph's bones are buried. She's a keeper of memory. She shares the name with Sera Callum, the first Anointed Wife (Vol. I, 417).
JONATHAN · 1 SAMUEL 18	**POSSIBLE** A man who looks at a rival and chooses alliance instead, "the soul of Jonathan was knit with the soul of David." **Where it breaks:** Jonathan's choice costs him a throne. Sera's survival costs Ruth hers, and Sera may never know (**TR**).

SHE'D QUOTE	NEVER READ TO HER
Ecclesiastes 3.7, "a time to keep silence, and a time to speak"	Judges 9.8–15, the bramble that takes the crown the olive, the fig and the vine refused

> **VOLUME ONE**
>
> Pacific, 555. Living memory, with her grandmother, 482. Echoes, labeled, with Jotham's fable, 419. David and Jonathan, 412.

Through the Trial

TKC: TR

CONFLICT

PHASE	WHAT THE FILES GIVE	YOURS
The Settling	Meets Eden on the first day and makes a decision that afternoon (TR)	
The Dominion Forum	Watches Eden for forty minutes and moves from competing to working beside her. Eden notices at once. Four words in the hallway after (TR).	
Before Endurance	Corinne's trap, and Sera walks into it because she sees too clearly to stay quiet. Judah trades Ruth to keep her (TR).	
Endurance	Reaches the final checkpoint (TR)	
After	Advances. The flag is updated, privately (TR).	

CONFLICT Two decision points, one on the Settling's first day and one forty minutes into the Forum (TR). Both can stand if the first is about Eden and the second about the room.

WHAT CORINNE'S TRAP IS

TKC: TR

Eden and Sera

THE FILES	Short of a friend for now. She's someone else who sees the room clearly and has decided two people who see clearly are more dangerous than one (**TR**).

THE FOUR WORDS

WHAT SERA WAS WAITING FOR, AND HOW SHE KNEW IT WAS EDEN

LINES ONLY SERA WOULD SAY

Write the hallway

WRITING

Ten minutes. The Forum's over, the corridor outside, a camera somewhere, and four words.

WRITE

☐ POSSIBLE ☐ OPEN QUESTION ☐ DECIDED

LOG NO. _____ DATE _____

NOTES

ANYTHING THIS SPREAD STARTED AND DID NOT FINISH